



PHISHING AWARENESS TRAINING

Recognize the bait. Protect the catch.



AGENDA

What we'll cover in this training module



1

What Is Phishing?

Definition and why it matters

2

Types of Phishing Attacks

Email, spear, whaling, smishing & more

3

Spotting Fake Emails & Websites

Red flags to watch for

4

Social Engineering Tactics

Psychological tricks attackers use

5

Real-World Case Studies

Lessons from major breaches

6

Best Practices & Quiz

Defense tips + interactive test

What Is Phishing?

Phishing is a cyberattack where criminals impersonate trusted organizations or people — via email, text, or fake websites — to trick victims into revealing passwords, financial details, or installing malware.

3.4B

phishing emails sent daily
worldwide

#1

attack vector for data breaches

90%

of successful cyberattacks start
with phishing



"Phishing" = Fishing

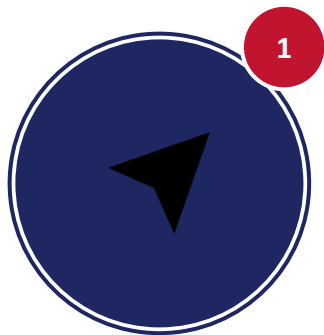
*Attackers cast bait (a fake message) hoping someone bites
— just like a fisherman with a hook.*

Goal: steal credentials, money, or install malware

Delivered via email, SMS, calls, or fake sites

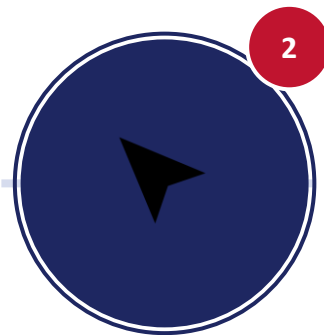
How a Phishing Attack Works

Five steps from the first email to a compromised account



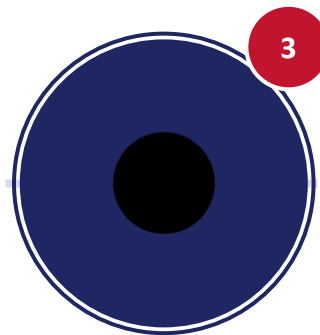
Bait Sent

Attacker emails/texts a fake but convincing message



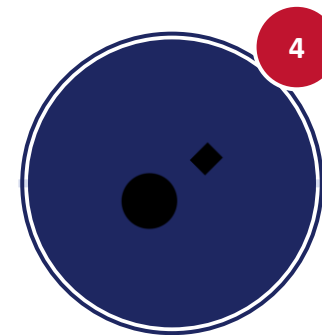
Victim Engages

Curiosity or urgency drives a click on the link



Fake Page Loads

A cloned login page collects credentials



Credentials Stolen

Attacker captures the username & password entered



Account Compromised

Attacker logs in, steals data or moves money

Breaking the chain at any step — not clicking, not entering credentials, or spotting the fake page — stops the attack.

Types of Phishing Attacks

Attackers adapt their bait to the channel and the target



Email Phishing

Mass fake emails impersonating banks, brands or services



Spear Phishing

Highly targeted attack aimed at a specific person or role



Whaling

Spear phishing aimed at executives / senior leadership



Smishing

Phishing delivered via SMS text messages



Vishing

Voice call phishing, often impersonating support or bank staff

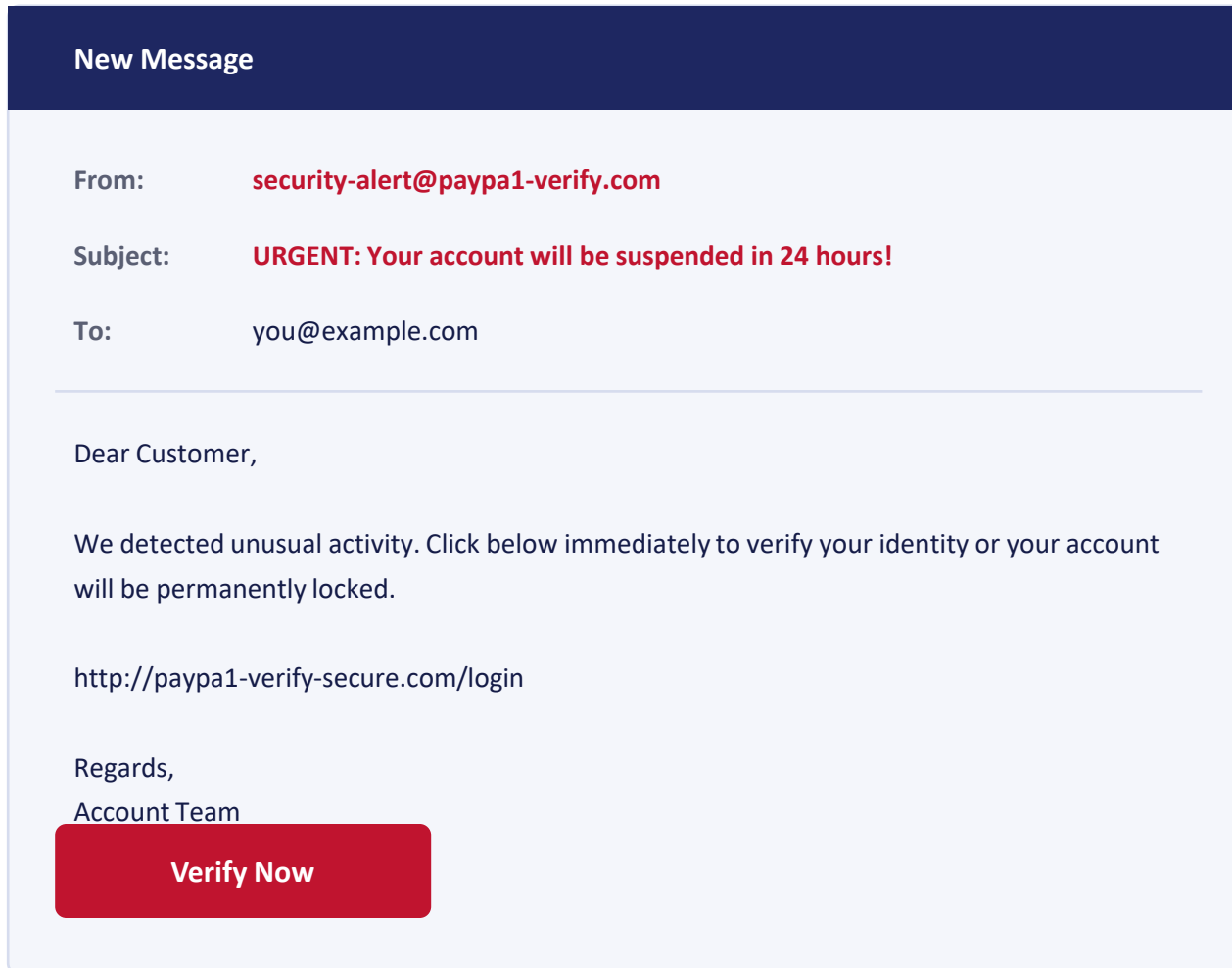


Clone Phishing

A legitimate email is copied and resent with malicious links

Anatomy of a Phishing Email

Red flags that give a fake email away



Misspelled domain

"paypa1" uses a 1 instead of l



Urgency & threats

Pressures you to act without thinking



Generic greeting

"Dear Customer" instead of your name



Suspicious link

Hover to check — URL doesn't match the real site



Unexpected attachment or request

Asks for sensitive info via email

Recognizing Fake Websites

Before entering any credentials, check the address bar



No HTTPS / padlock

Missing padlock or 'Not Secure' warning in the browser



Odd domain name

Extra words, hyphens, or misspellings, e.g. amaz0n-support.net



Poor design & typos

Low-quality logos, broken layout, grammar mistakes



Pop-ups demanding info

Legit sites rarely pop up asking for passwords instantly



Too-good offers

Unrealistic discounts or prizes to lure quick clicks



Redirect chains

URL changes multiple times before landing on the form

Social Engineering Tactics

Attackers exploit psychology, not just technology



Urgency

"Act now or lose access" — pressure short-circuits careful thinking



Authority

Impersonating a boss, bank, or government official



Trust & Familiarity

Posing as a known contact or coworker



Fear

Threats of fines, legal action, or account suspension



Curiosity

"You won't believe this" links or shocking headlines



Greed

Fake prizes, refunds, or investment opportunities

Real-World Case Study #1

The \$100M Facebook & Google Invoice Scam

2013 – 2015

Attacker: Lithuanian national Evaldas Rimasauskas set up a fake company with a name nearly identical to a real hardware supplier used by both tech giants.

Method: He sent forged invoices, contracts, and emails impersonating the legitimate vendor, requesting wire transfers to bank accounts he controlled.

Impact: Both companies wired over \$100 million combined before the fraud was discovered. Most funds were eventually recovered after a lengthy investigation.



Key Lesson

Always verify payment or invoice changes through a second, independent channel — a phone call to a known number, not the one in the email.

Real-World Case Study #2

The 2020 Twitter Bitcoin Scam

July 2020

Method: Attackers used a vishing (voice phishing) campaign, calling Twitter employees while posing as IT support to steal their internal login credentials.

Result: They gained access to Twitter's internal admin tools and hijacked high-profile verified accounts (Elon Musk, Barack Obama, Apple, and others), posting a Bitcoin double-your-money scam.

Impact: Over \$118,000 in Bitcoin was collected from victims within hours, and it exposed how a single social engineering call can compromise an entire platform.



Key Lesson

Even internal staff and trusted platforms are targets.
Verify identity through official channels before sharing credentials — over phone, chat, or email.

Best Practices & Prevention Tips

Simple habits that stop most phishing attacks



Verify the sender

Check the full email address, not just the display name



Hover before you click

Preview the actual URL destination before clicking any link



Enable MFA

Multi-factor authentication blocks most stolen-password attacks



Use a password manager

Prevents reuse and autofill on fake lookalike sites



Verify via a second channel

Call a known number to confirm unusual requests



Report & delete

Report suspicious emails to IT/security, then delete them

If You Fall Victim — Act Fast

Every minute counts — follow these steps immediately

1

Change your passwords

Immediately update credentials on the affected account and any reused elsewhere

2

Enable MFA

Add multi-factor authentication if it isn't already active

3

Contact your bank / IT team

Report the incident to your bank or organization's security team right away

4

Monitor your accounts

Watch for unauthorized transactions or login activity over the following weeks

5

Report the phishing attempt

Forward it to your IT/security team or platforms like reportphishing@apwg.org

Interactive Quiz — Test Yourself

Discuss each scenario as a group before revealing the answer

Q1

You get an email from "HR" asking you to confirm your salary bank account by clicking a link — urgently. What do you do?

A. Click and enter details fast B. Verify with HR directly, don't click C. Forward to a friend

Q2

A website URL reads "http://secure-login-bankofindia.co" instead of the bank's real domain. Is this safe?

A. Yes, it says 'secure' B. No — mismatched/suspicious domain C. Can't tell without opening it

Q3

You receive a call from someone claiming to be tech support asking for your OTP to "fix an issue." What's the right move?

A. Share the OTP to resolve it fast B. Hang up — legitimate support never asks for OTP C. Share only half the OTP

Quiz Answers & Why



Q1 → B

Never confirm sensitive info via an emailed link. Verify directly with HR through a known phone number or in person.



Q2 → B

Mismatched or unfamiliar domains are a major red flag, even if the page looks official or says 'secure'.

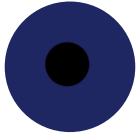


Q3 → B

Legitimate support teams never ask for your OTP. Sharing it hands over full access to your account.

Key Takeaways

The five habits that stop almost every phishing attempt



Slow down and inspect

Check sender address, domain spelling, and links before acting



Urgency is a red flag

Legitimate organizations rarely demand instant action



Verify independently

Confirm unusual requests via a known phone number or in person



Layer your defenses

MFA, password managers, and updated software reduce your risk



Report, don't ignore

Reporting suspicious messages protects you and your organization



Stay Alert. Stay Secure.

When in doubt, don't click — verify first.

Thank You

CodeAlpha Cyber Security Internship — Task 2